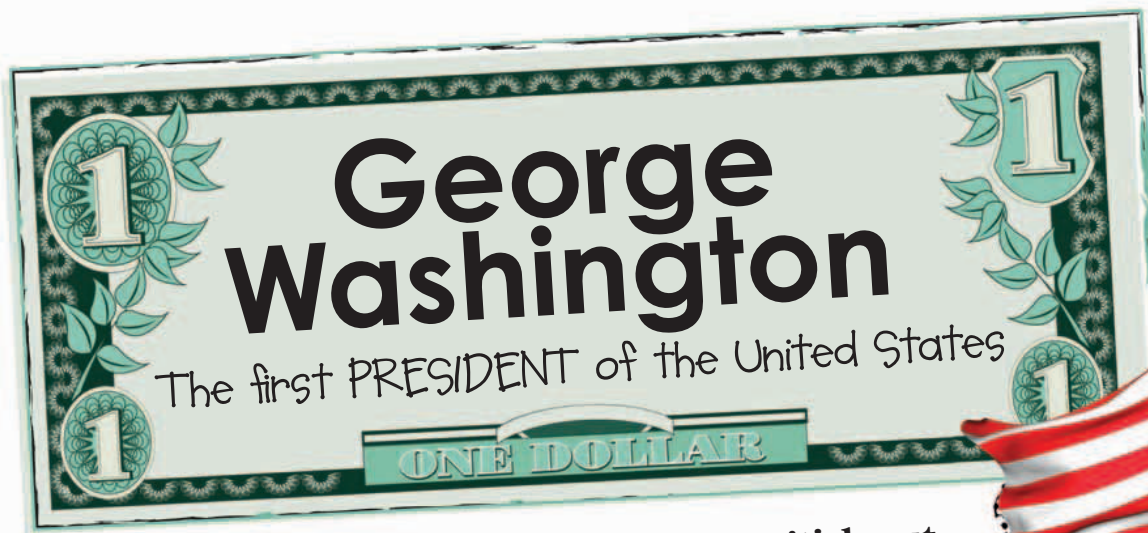




George Washington helped to kick the British out of America. He became a national hero, the first President of the United States of America, and got his face on a lot of coins and banknotes.



The wily woodsman

Washington was born in 1732 in Westmoreland County, Virginia, USA. His father died when he was 11, and he had very **little formal schooling**, but George taught himself to be a woodsman, surveyor, and mapmaker. This all came in useful when, at 20, he joined the **VIRGINIA MILITIA** who, at the time, were fighting for the British (who ruled much of America) **against the French and their Native American allies**.

The crafty commander

When the British won the war, they raised taxes to pay for it. This was very unpopular, so on **July 4, 1776**, the Americans declared independence and went to war with Britain. Washington was commander of the Continental Army in the **REVOLUTIONARY WAR** and, knowing he could never beat the British in a pitched battle, ordered his troops to attack quickly and then withdraw to safety. By using **clever tactics**, he was able to defeat the British.

On Christmas Day 1776, Washington led his troops across the icy Delaware River, where he surprised and defeated the British. It was a major turning point of the Revolutionary War.

Did you know?
George proposed to his wife, Martha Dandridge Custis, after knowing her for only three weeks and only meeting her twice!

He couldn't have done it without...



Merchant and statesman
JOHN HANCOCK
(1737–1793) was the first person to sign the **DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE**.